

Zeynep Arslan

Financial Planning & Analysis Manager | CFA Charterholder

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CFA Charterholder and FP&A; Manager with 8+ years of experience in financial modeling, budgeting, and strategic planning within FMCG and retail sectors. Adept at translating complex financial data into actionable business insights for C-suite stakeholders. Proven ability to streamline reporting processes and drive cost efficiency across large organizations.

WORK EXPERIENCE

FP&A; Manager

Migros Ticaret A.Ş. – İzmir, Türkiye

Feb 2020 – Present

- Led annual budgeting and quarterly forecasting cycles for a portfolio with €1.8B in annual revenue.
- Built a dynamic 3-statement financial model that reduced month-end close process from 8 days to 4 days.
- Delivered monthly executive dashboards to CFO and board, synthesizing KPIs across 500+ store locations.
- Identified €12M in cost savings through variance analysis and renegotiation of supplier contracts.
- Managed and developed a team of 5 financial analysts; introduced structured analyst development program.

Senior Financial Analyst

Unilever Türkiye – İstanbul, Türkiye

Mar 2017 – Jan 2020

- Prepared category P&L; reports and scenario analyses supporting pricing and promotion decisions.
- Coordinated cross-functional budget reviews with Marketing, Supply Chain, and Sales teams.
- Automated recurring reports using Excel VBA and Power Query, saving 15 analyst-hours per month.
- Supported M&A; due diligence for two acquisition targets totaling €90M in transaction value.

Financial Analyst

Garanti BBVA – İstanbul, Türkiye

Sep 2015 – Feb 2017

- Analyzed commercial loan portfolios and prepared credit risk assessment reports.
- Built DCF and comparable company analysis models for corporate banking clients.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Economics

Bilkent Üniversitesi – Ankara, Türkiye

Sep 2011 – Jun 2015 | GPA: 3.68 / 4.00 | Full Scholarship

- Dean's List all 8 semesters. Thesis: 'Inflation Targeting and Monetary Policy in Emerging Markets'.

CFA Program – All 3 Levels Passed

CFA Institute – Charlottesville, VA, USA

Chartered: 2019

SKILLS & TOOLS

Finance:	Financial Modeling, DCF, LBO, Budgeting, Forecasting, Variance Analysis, P&L; Management
Reporting:	Power BI, Tableau, SAP BPC, Hyperion, Oracle Financials, IBM Cognos
Productivity:	Excel (Advanced – VBA, Power Query), PowerPoint, Word, SharePoint
Programming:	Python (pandas, matplotlib – intermediate), SQL (intermediate)
Soft Skills:	Executive Presentation, Cross-functional Leadership, Stakeholder Management

CERTIFICATIONS & MEMBERSHIPS

- CFA Charterholder – CFA Institute (2019)
- Financial Modeling & Valuation Analyst (FMVA) – CFI (2021)
- Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst Associate (2022)
- Member – CFA Society Turkey

LANGUAGES

Türkçe (Anadil) | İngilizce (C2 – Proficient) | Almanca (B2 – Upper Intermediate)